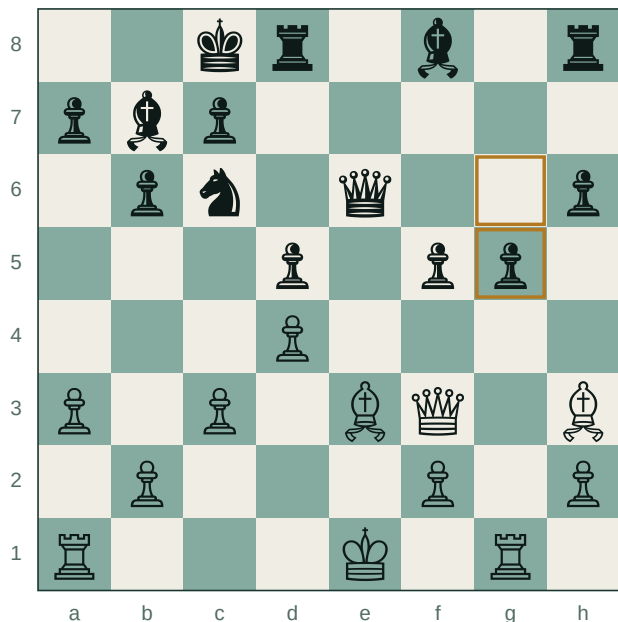


Pins and pressure: White, move 19

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 18...g5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19. Bxf5 Qxf5 20. Qxf5+

19.Bxf5 The bishop captures the pawn on f5. Recorded reply: **19...Qxf5**.

20.Qxf5+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From f5 it attacks king on c8 and bishop on f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +7. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +7: the balance goes from -4 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on c8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and queen on e6. Check for tactical protection.